TOPIC 3 · 8 MIN · DOCS · GMAIL · CALENDAR · DRIVE

Lab 8: Schedules: Close the Lid and See What Always-On Means

> Google's own pages disagree on whether schedules run with your device off. Find out for yourself.

Your goal

Test always-on on your own account, then set a read-only morning brief (LO3).

The story so far

Before you hand Spark anything on a timer, you check the claim. Then you give it its safest recurring job: a morning brief that reads a lot and changes nothing.

You will deliver

- ☐ Your close-the-lid result, written down
- ☐ A daily morning brief schedule

Before you start

A personal Google Account on Google AI Pro or Ultra, age 18+, Keep Activity and Personal Intelligence on. A laptop with Chrome. Copy every prompt from labs/prompts.html, or from the course prompts page: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/TGS-2026064173-AI-Agents-with-Gemini-Spark/labs/prompts.html

Your mock data

File in data/	What it is
lid-test-record.txt	A one-line form for your result.

Steps

Step 1. Before the break: set the test (2 min)

Where: Gemini → Task

Paste the prompt just before the tea break, check it appears under Scheduled, then close your laptop lid until the break ends.

PROMPT · COPY FROM THE LAB PROMPTS PAGE

```
In about 8 minutes, one time only, create a Google Doc named Northstar-Lid-Test in my Gemini Spark Workspace/Northstar folder containing one line with the date and time it ran. Do nothing else.
```

Expect: A schedule shows under Active. The result comes after the break.

You decide: Run times are approximate, so judge by whether it ran at all.

Step 2. Read the result and set the brief (6 min)

Where: Google Drive, then Gemini → Task

Open your laptop. Did Northstar-Lid-Test appear, and what time does it show? Fill in lid-test-record.txt. Then paste the prompt, go to Scheduled, hover and click More → Run now.

PROMPT · COPY FROM THE LAB PROMPTS PAGE

```
Every weekday around 7 AM Singapore time, look through [NORTHSTAR-LAB] emails, my calendar
named Northstar Lab and my Northstar folder. Tell me what to prioritise today, with
enquiries waiting for a reply at the top.
Do not send anything.
```

Expect: A brief in the task thread. A timestamp or no file: either is a valid finding.

You decide: What does your lid result mean for anything you schedule?

Checkpoint

You have a timestamp, or a documented no-show, and a schedule that sends nothing.

If you finish early, or after class

• Add a topic monitor: when a new Google Workspace feature for small businesses makes the news, email me a summary.

If Spark does not behave as described

Menus move and results vary, so this lab states what to expect and not exact wording. Check the source in Google Help, tell your trainer, and record what you actually saw. No Pro or Ultra account in class? Pair with a neighbour and complete the Docs, Sheets and Sites templates by hand.

All company data in this lab (Northstar Studio, people, enquiries, reviews, numbers) is fictional and generated for training.